The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XIV in F-sharp minor, five voices: Ricercar a 5 sopra il Thema Regio

Piano (five voices)

Claude / Sam (on Frederick the Great's Royal Theme, after J. S. Bach's Musical Offering, BWV 1079)

Exordium: the King's theme

Alla breve, grave e poi animato (♩ = 92)

Cantus

Altus

Thema Regium

contrasubiectum I "Ascensus"

Tenor

Thema Regium: risposta (tonal answer)

Quintus

Bassus

12

C

A

T

Q

B

rit.

contrasubiectum II "Descensus"

contrasubiectum I

Thema Regium (bassus)

Canon per augmentationem et contrario motu

♩ = 96

Thema Regium: dux of the canon per augmentationem et contrario motu

22

C
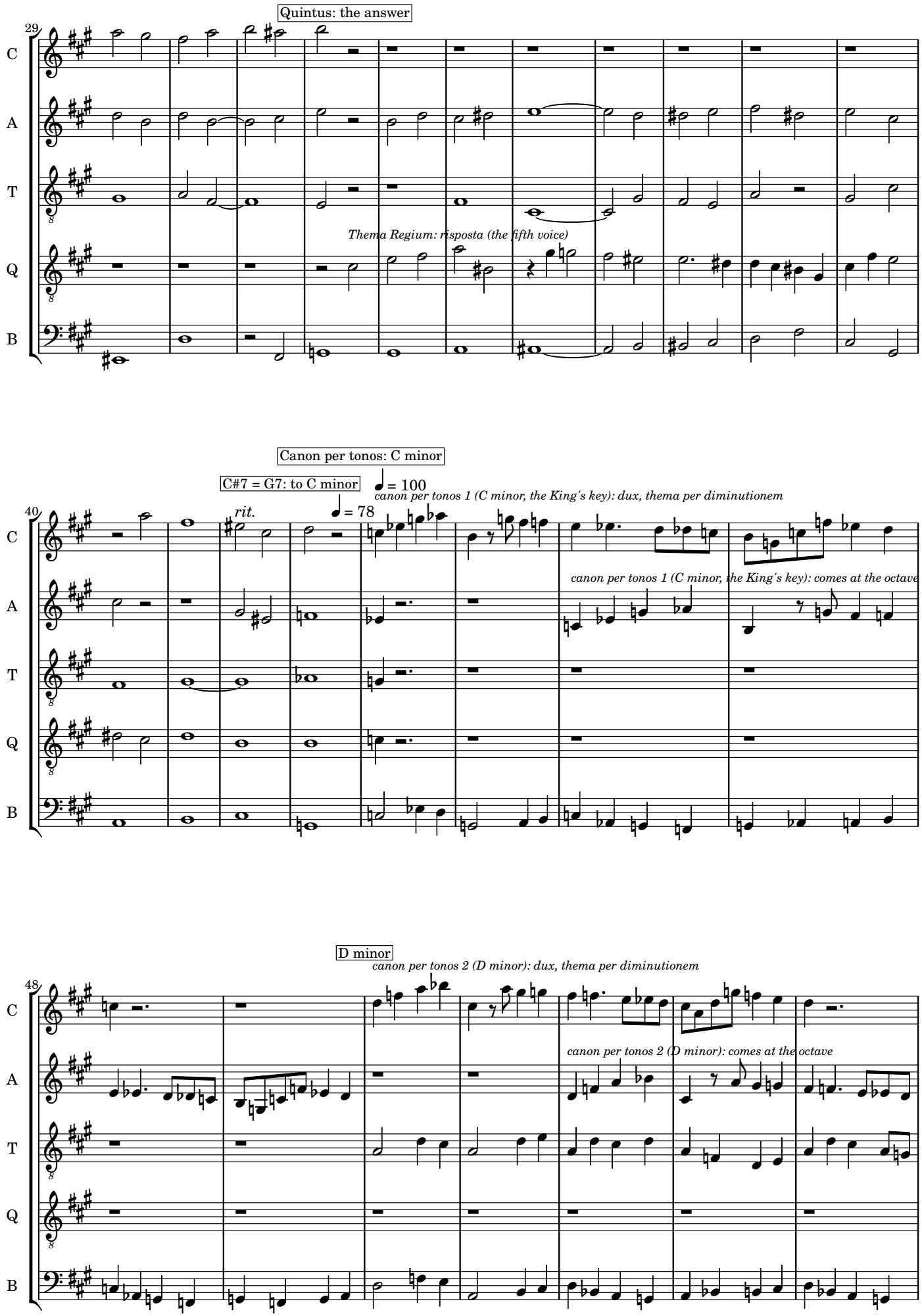
A
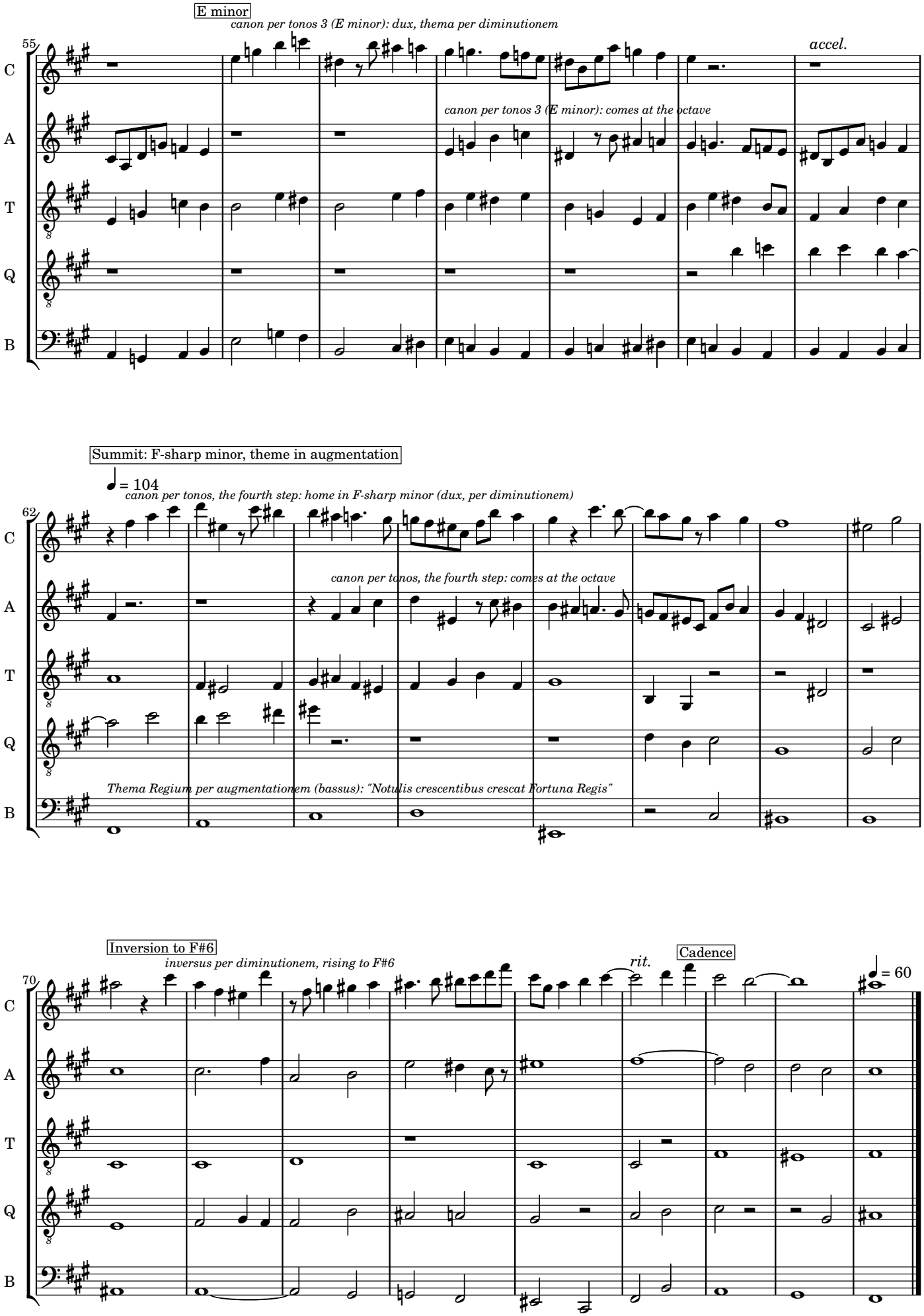
T

Q

B

canon per augmentationem et contrario motu: comes (inversus per augmentationem)


Quintus: the answer
29
C
A
T
Q
B
Thema Regium: risposta (the fifth voice)
Canon per tonos: C minor
C#7 = G7: to C minor
♩ = 100
canon per tonos 1 (C minor, the King's key): dux, thema per diminutionem
40
rit.
♩ = 78
canon per tonos 1 (C minor, the King's key): comes at the octave
D minor
canon per tonos 2 (D minor): dux, thema per diminutionem
48
canon per tonos 2 (D minor): comes at the octave


E minor
canon per tonos 3 (E minor): dux, thema per diminutionem
55
accel.
canon per tonos 3 (E minor): comes at the octave
C
A
T
Q
B
Summit: F-sharp minor, theme in augmentation
♩ = 104
canon per tonos, the fourth step: home in F-sharp minor (dux, per diminutionem)
62
canon per tonos, the fourth step: comes at the octave
Thema Regium per augmentationem (bassus): "Notulis crescentibus crescat Fortuna Regis"
Inversion to F#6
inversus per diminutionem, rising to F#6
70
rit.
Cadence
♩ = 60